QUANTUS INSIGHTS

STATEWIDE SURVEY OF LIKELY VOTERS · GENERAL ELECTION

Texas U.S. Senate and Governor Survey

The Paxton and Talarico Senate ballot and the Abbott and Hinojosa Governor ballot, one week before Election Day: toplines, ballots with leaners, demographic detail, the state in context, and movement since the October 9 to 11 survey.

FIELDED	RESPONDENTS	POPULATION	EFFECTIVE N	MARGIN OF ERROR
October 26 to 28, 2026	1,221	Likely voters	954	±3.2

Prepared by Jason B. Corley, Co-founder and Lead Pollster | quantusinsights.org

EXECUTIVE BRIEF

Two close statewide ballots, one week out

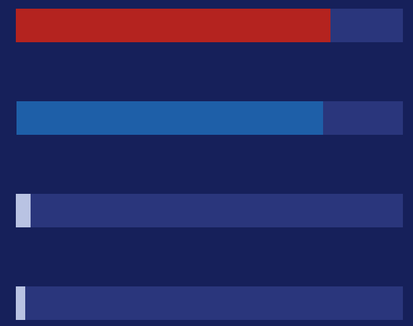
Initial ballot and the ballot with leaners allocated, in percent of likely voters who will vote in each race.

U.S. SENATE · Q2

Race voters only, n=1,207

Paxton +1.1

initial ballot margin



WITH LEANERS ALLOCATED

Paxton +1.0

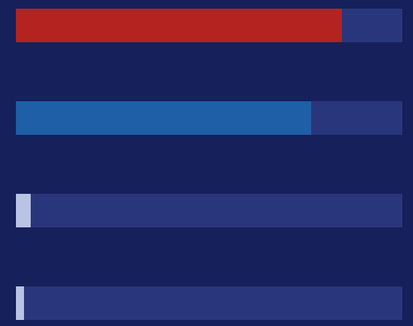
49.4	48.4	1.4	0.8
Ken Paxton (R)	James Talarico (D)	Ted Brown (L)	Undecided

GOVERNOR · Q4

Race voters only, n=1,214

Abbott +4.9

initial ballot margin



WITH LEANERS ALLOCATED

Abbott +5.3

51.6	46.3	1.2	1.0
Greg Abbott (R)	Gina Hinojosa (D)	Pat Dixon (L)	Undecided

THE SENATE RACE

Paxton 48.7, Talarico 47.6, a 1.1-point edge inside the roughly ±6.4 margin on a difference between two candidates. 2.2 percent are undecided and Ted Brown, the Libertarian, draws 1.4. With leaners allocated the ballot is 49.4 to 48.4.

THE GOVERNOR RACE

Abbott 50.7, Hinojosa 45.8, a 4.9-point lead that is also inside the margin on a difference. 2.3 percent are undecided and Pat Dixon, the Libertarian, draws 1.2. With leaners allocated the ballot is 51.6 to 46.3.

TURNOUT AND TICKETS

54.3 percent of likely voters had already voted by the end of fieldwork, 51.7 early in person and 2.6 by mail. 47.3 percent plan a straight Republican ticket and 46.0 percent a straight Democratic ticket.

KEY FINDINGS

What the survey shows

Six findings from the October 26 to 28 survey, with the context needed to read each one.

01

A Senate race inside the margin

Paxton 48.7 to Talarico 47.6 among race voters. The margin on a difference between two candidates is about ±6.4, so neither nominee holds a measurable lead. The 27 undecided respondents who were pushed to lean split 31.1 Talarico to 30.7 Paxton with 38.2 percent still undecided; allocating them moves the ballot to 49.4 to 48.4.

02

Abbott ahead, inside the margin

Abbott 50.7 to Hinojosa 45.8, a 4.9-point lead. Abbott runs 2.0 points ahead of Paxton and Hinojosa 1.8 points behind Talarico, which is the whole of the gap between the two races. With leaners allocated Abbott reaches 51.6.

03

Independents and the suburbs

Independents, 13.9 percent of the sample, back Talarico 57 to 33 with 6 percent undecided; for Governor they go Hinojosa 54 to 36. The suburbs are Paxton 49 to 47 on the Senate ballot and Abbott 50 to 45 for Governor.

04

Gender, age and place

Women favor Talarico 52 to 45; men favor Paxton 54 to 43. Voters under 45 go Talarico and voters 45 and over go Paxton; voters 65 and over go Paxton 57 to 40. Urban voters go Talarico 61 to 36; rural voters go Paxton 66 to 31. The Governor ballot follows the same pattern with Hinojosa a few points below Talarico in each group.

05

Most of the vote is already in

51.7 percent of likely voters had voted early in person and 2.6 percent by mail by the end of fieldwork; 19.8 percent planned to vote early before it ended on October 30 and 22.5 percent on Election Day. Democrats report having voted at a higher rate, 59 percent, than Republicans, 49 percent, or independents, 41 percent.

06

Movement since October 9 to 11

The Senate ballot moved from Paxton 47.2 to 46.7 to Paxton 48.7 to 47.6, a 0.6-point shift toward Paxton on the margin. Undecided fell from 3.9 to 2.2 and Brown from 2.2 to 1.4. Both surveys are inside their margins of error; the movement slide gives the group detail.

BOTTOM LINE

Results are a weighted snapshot of the electorate at the time of fieldwork. Differences within the margin of error should not be characterized as decisive.

METHODOLOGY

How this survey was conducted

ANALYTICAL LIKELY-VOTER N	EFFECTIVE N	DESIGN EFFECT	MARGIN OF ERROR
1,221	954	1.28	±3.2

POPULATION

The survey represents likely voters in the 2026 Texas general election. A likely-voter screen was used to define and weight the survey population, drawing on voting history, demographics, partisan-lean indicators and voter-file geography. Weighting benchmarks were constructed from the voter-file research universe so that every target reflects the actual composition of Texas's likely electorate.

UNIVERSE

Active registered Texas voter-file records. Respondents were contacted through SMS invitations sent to mobile phones. Of 1,221 completed interviews, respondents who said they would not vote in a given race are removed from that race only: 14 from the Senate ballot, leaving a race-voters base of 1,207, and 7 from the Governor ballot, leaving 1,214.

FIELD PERIOD AND MODE

October 26 to 28, 2026. SMS-to-mobile cell interviews. Stratified random sampling from the eligible universe, matched to available contact records.

WEIGHTING

Iterative proportional fitting, or raking, to benchmarks for the Texas likely general-election electorate on six dimensions: sex, age range, race and ethnicity (modeled), education (modeled), metro type and congressional district. Weights were trimmed to limit the influence of individual respondents and renormalized each iteration.

MARGIN OF ERROR

±3.2 percentage points at the 95 percent confidence level, design-adjusted, for the full sample of 1,221. The design effect is 1.28, for an effective sample size of approximately 954. Subgroup margins are larger. The margin on the difference between two candidates is roughly twice the single-share margin, about ±6.4. Uncertainty was additionally checked with 400 reraked bootstrap replicates.

REPORTING

Topline results are shown to one decimal; crosstab cells are whole-number column percentages within each subgroup. Base n is shown on every table. Cells marked * rest on limited bases and are directional only. Race, ethnicity and education are modeled from the voter file; party is the mapped voter-file party field. Initial-ballot results and the combined ballot with leaners are presented as separate findings. Percentages may not total 100 due to rounding.

METHODOLOGY

Survey intelligence pipeline

Quantus Insights processes each study through a multi-stage survey intelligence pipeline that evaluates sample composition, coverage, geographic balance, and statistical stability.

01

BENCHMARKS AND WEIGHTS

The pipeline applies the study's likely-voter criteria and weighting benchmarks, monitors the distribution and influence of survey weights, and evaluates convergence with the intended electorate.

02

RESPONSE-BIAS AUDIT

Because respondents are drawn from the voter file, the pipeline also audits who within each demographic, partisan and geographic cell responded, comparing reported prior-cycle vote against certified results to detect response bias that demographic raking cannot.

03

CALIBRATION AND STABILITY

Where indicated, final weights are calibrated to official prior-cycle returns; calibration targets come from certified election results, never from the survey's own recall distribution. Effective sample size, subgroup stability, missing-data patterns and response-propensity checks against the universe are reviewed throughout.

04

EXPERT OVERSIGHT

Statistical automation is paired with expert methodological oversight to validate data quality, confirm the appropriate use of variables and benchmarks, and identify irregularities requiring further review. This combination provides a rigorous and consistent framework for producing estimates representative of the defined survey population.

THIS STUDY

The pipeline's checks run on the full reporting base of 1,221 before any result in this report is produced. The reported design effect of 1.28 and effective sample size of 954 are outputs of that review. Race, ethnicity and education use the mapped modeled voter-file fields selected for this study; party uses the mapped voter-file party field.

SAMPLE COMPOSITION

Full respondent sample profile

Weighted composition of the full study reporting base after calibration. Counts are unweighted respondents.

1,221

reporting base

GENDER

Women	54.2	n=662
Men	45.8	n=559

AGE

18-29	10.7	n=131
30-44	21.4	n=261
45-64	36.1	n=441
65+	31.8	n=388

RACE / ETHNICITY (MODELED)

White	59.5	n=727
Hispanic	23.8	n=290
Black	10.3	n=126
Asian	3.7	n=45
Other	2.7	n=33

EDUCATION (MODELED)

HS-Some College	57.9	n=707
College	26.8	n=327
Graduate School	15.3	n=187

PARTY ID (MODELED)

Republican	46.7	n=570
Democrat	39.4	n=481
Independent	13.9	n=170

METRO TYPE

Urban	37.3	n=456
Suburban	33.4	n=408
Rural	22.3	n=272
Town	7.0	n=85

MEDIA MARKET

Dallas-Ft. Worth	31.5	n=385
Houston	25.1	n=306
San Antonio	10.5	n=128
Austin	10.0	n=122
Waco-Temple-Bryan	3.3	n=40
Corpus Christi	3.2	n=39
Tyler-Longview (Lfkn & Ncgd)	2.9	n=36
El Paso (Las Cruces)	2.0	n=24
Harlingen-Wslco-Brnsvl-McA	1.7	n=21
Amarillo	1.6	n=20
Lubbock	1.4	n=17
Beaumont-Port Arthur	1.3	n=16
Shreveport	1.2	n=15
Abilene-Sweetwater	1.0	n=12
Odessa-Midland	0.8	n=10
Five smallest markets combined	2.5	n=30

Counts are the full reporting base of 1,221.

The Senate ballot uses the race-voters base of 1,207 (14 would-not-vote respondents removed); the Governor ballot uses 1,214 (7 removed); the 2024 recall question uses 1,168 (53 who did not vote in 2024 removed).

Party is the mapped voter-file field: 46.7 Republican, 39.4 Democrat, 13.9 independent.

The four largest media markets carry 77 percent of the sample. The five smallest markets (Laredo, Wichita Falls and Lawton, Victoria, San Angelo, and Sherman-Ada) are combined here; the full report lists each separately. Media-market crosstabs in this deck show the four markets with bases above 100.

SECTION ONE

The U.S. Senate ballot

The Paxton and Talarico ballot, the ballot with leaners allocated, demographic and media-market detail, and movement since the October 9 to 11 survey.

QUESTIONS

Q2, Q3

STRUCTURE

Topline, leaners, demographic detail, trend

BASES

n = 1,207 race voters; Q3 n = 27

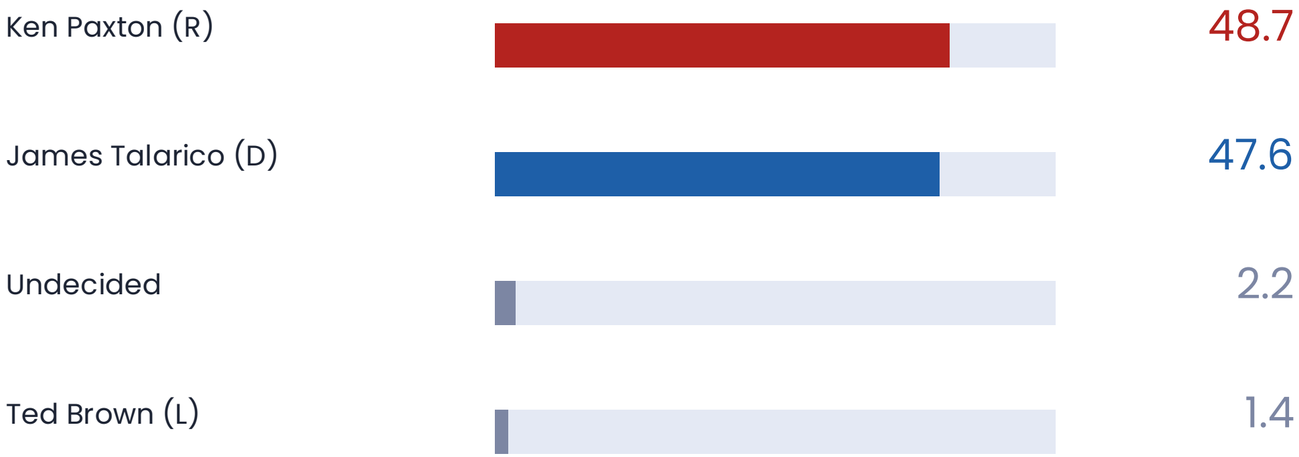
Q2 · U.S. SENATE BALLOT

If the election for U.S. Senate in Texas were held today, for whom would you vote?

Asked of race voters, n=1,207. Respondents who had already voted were asked for whom they voted.

Paxton +1.1

Paxton margin, initial ballot



TWO-WAY SHARE



MARGIN BY GROUP

Women	Talarico +7
Men	Paxton +11
Independents	Talarico +24
Suburban	Paxton +2
Rural	Paxton +35
Hispanic voters	Talarico +23

THE MARGIN

Paxton leads by 1.1 points. The margin on a difference between two candidates is about ±6.4, so the result is a statistical tie. Two-way share divides each nominee by the two-candidate total.

THE REST OF THE BALLOT

Ted Brown, the Libertarian, draws 1.4 percent; 2.2 percent are undecided. The 14 respondents who would not vote in this race are excluded from the base, and the remaining responses are renormalized to 100.

REPORTING NOTE

Column percentages on the race-voters base of 1,207. Group margins are differences in whole-number column percentages from the crosstabs; topline margins are computed from unrounded shares.

Q2 + Q3 · SENATE BALLOT WITH LEANERS

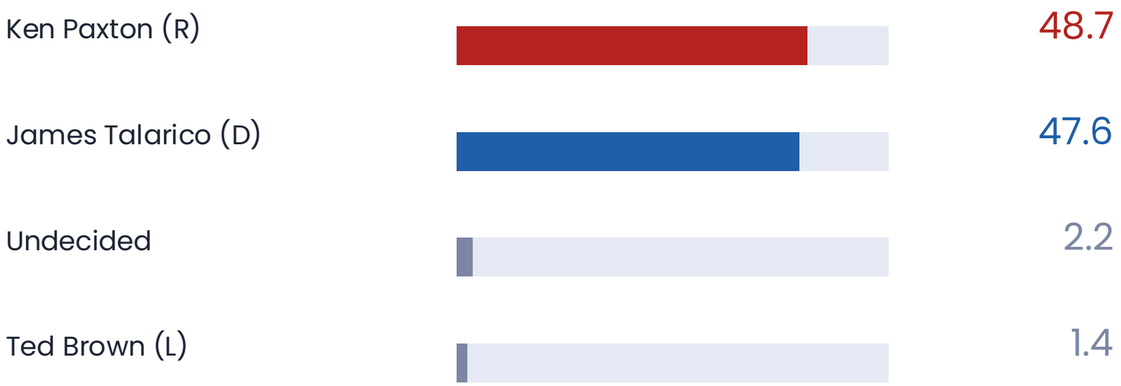
Even if you are not sure, which candidate for U.S. Senate do you lean toward?

Paxton +1.0

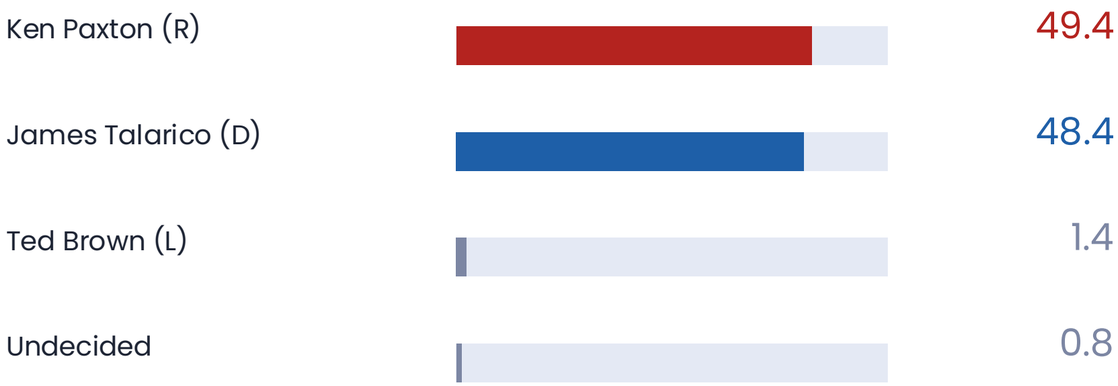
Paxton margin, with leaners

Asked of the 27 undecided respondents on Q2. Leaners are allocated back into the ballot to produce the combined result.

INITIAL BALLOT · Q2 · N=1,207



BALLOT WITH LEANERS ALLOCATED · N=1,207



HOW THE 27 UNDECIDED RESPONDENTS BROKE · Q3 · BASE N=27, DIRECTIONAL

38.2	Still undecided n=10	31.1	James Talarico, the Democrat n=9	30.7	Ken Paxton, the Republican n=8

WHAT CHANGED

Allocating leaners adds 0.7 to Paxton and 0.8 to Talarico; the ballot goes from 48.7 to 47.6 to 49.4 to 48.4. Undecided falls from 2.2 to 0.8 percent. Brown is unchanged at 1.4.

HOW TO READ IT

The lean question was asked of 27 people, so the split is directional. The leaners divided almost evenly, so the combined ballot moves the margin by only a tenth of a point.

REPORTING NOTE

Combined ballot shares come from the report's derived analysis (Paxton n=596, Talarico n=584, Brown n=17, undecided n=10 on the 1,207 base). Initial and combined results are separate findings.

If the election for U.S. Senate in Texas were held today, for whom would you vote?

Whole-number column percentages within each subgroup. Race-voters base n=1,207, margin of error ±3.2.

Paxton +1.1

Paxton margin, initial ballot

GENDER

RESPONSE	WOMEN n=655	MEN n=552
Ken Paxton, Republican	45%	54%
James Talarico, Democrat	52%	43%
Undecided	2%	2%
Ted Brown, Libertarian	1%	2%
Margin	Talarico +7	Paxton +11

AGE

RESPONSE	18-29 n=129	30-44 n=260	45-64 n=433	65+ n=385
Ken Paxton, Republican	28%	39%	53%	57%
James Talarico, Democrat	66%	55%	45%	40%
Undecided	3%	3%	1%	2%
Ted Brown, Libertarian	3%	2%	1%	1%
Margin	Talarico +38	Talarico +16	Paxton +8	Paxton +17

RACE / ETHNICITY (MODELED)

RESPONSE	WHITE n=721	HISPANIC n=286	BLACK n=124	ASIAN* n=44	OTHER* n=32
Ken Paxton, Republican	61%	36%	13%	40%	37%
James Talarico, Democrat	36%	59%	84%	53%	60%
Undecided	2%	3%	3%	3%	2%
Ted Brown, Libertarian	1%	2%	0%	3%	1%
Margin	Paxton +25	Talarico +23	Talarico +71	Talarico +13	Talarico +23

EDUCATION

RESPONSE	HS-SOME COLLEGE n=699	COLLEGE n=327	GRADUATE SCHOOL n=181
Ken Paxton, Republican	54%	41%	40%
James Talarico, Democrat	41%	54%	60%
Undecided	3%	2%	0%
Ted Brown, Libertarian	1%	2%	0%
Margin	Paxton +13	Talarico +13	Talarico +20

GENDER AND AGE

Women back Talarico by 7 points; men back Paxton by 11. Voters under 30 go Talarico by 38 and 30 to 44 by 16; voters 45 to 64 go Paxton by 8 and 65 and over by 17.

RACE AND EDUCATION

White voters go Paxton 61 to 36; Hispanic voters go Talarico 59 to 36 and Black voters 84 to 13. Voters with a high school education or some college go Paxton 54 to 41; college graduates go Talarico 54 to 41.

REPORTING NOTE

* = limited base, directional. Race and education are modeled from the voter file. Percentages run down each column and may not total 100 due to rounding.

If the election for U.S. Senate in Texas were held today, for whom would you vote?

Whole-number column percentages within each subgroup. Race-voters base n=1,207, margin of error ±3.2.

Paxton +1.1

Paxton margin, initial ballot

PARTY ID (MODELED)

RESPONSE	REPUBLICAN n=563	DEMOCRAT n=477	INDEPENDENT n=167
Ken Paxton, Republican	93%	2%	33%
James Talarico, Democrat	4%	96%	57%
Undecided	2%	2%	6%
Ted Brown, Libertarian	1%	1%	4%
Margin	Paxton +89	Talarico +94	Talarico +24

METRO TYPE

RESPONSE	URBAN n=451	SUBURBAN n=403	RURAL n=269	TOWN n=84
Ken Paxton, Republican	36%	49%	66%	61%
James Talarico, Democrat	61%	47%	31%	35%
Undecided	3%	2%	2%	2%
Ted Brown, Libertarian	0%	2%	2%	2%
Margin	Talarico +25	Paxton +2	Paxton +35	Paxton +26

MEDIA MARKET

RESPONSE	DALLAS-FT. WORTH n=381	HOUSTON n=305	SAN ANTONIO n=128	AUSTIN n=122
Ken Paxton, Republican	47%	46%	45%	36%
James Talarico, Democrat	48%	50%	52%	62%
Undecided	3%	2%	2%	1%
Ted Brown, Libertarian	2%	2%	1%	1%
Margin	Talarico +1	Talarico +4	Talarico +7	Talarico +26

PARTY

Republicans hold at 93 percent for Paxton and Democrats at 96 percent for Talarico. Independents go 57 Talarico to 33, with 6 percent undecided and 4 percent for Brown.

PLACE

Urban voters go Talarico by 25 and rural voters Paxton by 35; the suburbs are Paxton 49 to 47. Dallas-Ft. Worth is Talarico 48 to 47, Houston 50 to 46, San Antonio 52 to 45 and Austin 62 to 36.

REPORTING NOTE

Party is the mapped voter-file field. Media market shows the four markets with bases above 100; the sixteen smaller markets are directional and appear in the full report.

Senate ballot with leaners allocated, by demographic group

Whole-number column percentages within each subgroup after leaners are allocated. Base n=1,207. Column counts are calibrated weighted equivalents.

Paxton +1.0

Paxton margin, with leaners

GENDER

RESPONSE	WOMEN weighted n=655	MEN weighted n=552
Ken Paxton, Republican	45%	55%
James Talarico, Democrat	53%	43%
Ted Brown, Libertarian	1%	2%
Undecided	1%	1%
Margin	Talarico +8	Paxton +12

AGE

RESPONSE	18-29* weighted n=129	30-44 weighted n=260	45-64 weighted n=433	65+ weighted n=385
Ken Paxton, Republican	28%	40%	53%	58%
James Talarico, Democrat	67%	57%	45%	40%
Ted Brown, Libertarian	3%	2%	1%	1%
Undecided	1%	1%	1%	1%
Margin	Talarico +39	Talarico +17	Paxton +8	Paxton +18

RACE / ETHNICITY (MODELED)

RESPONSE	WHITE weighted n=721	HISPANIC weighted n=286	BLACK* weighted n=124	ASIAN* weighted n=44	OTHER* weighted n=32
Ken Paxton, Republican	62%	37%	13%	40%	37%
James Talarico, Democrat	36%	61%	85%	53%	60%
Ted Brown, Libertarian	1%	2%	0%	3%	1%
Undecided	1%	0%	2%	3%	2%
Margin	Paxton +26	Talarico +24	Talarico +72	Talarico +13	Talarico +23

EDUCATION

RESPONSE	HIGH SCHOOL weighted n=699	COLLEGE weighted n=327	GRADUATE SCHOOL weighted n=181
Ken Paxton, Republican	56%	42%	40%
James Talarico, Democrat	42%	55%	60%
Ted Brown, Libertarian	1%	2%	0%
Undecided	1%	1%	0%
Margin	Paxton +14	Talarico +13	Talarico +20

WHAT MOVES

Allocating the 27 leaners changes most groups by a point or less. Women go from Talarico +7 to +8; men from Paxton +11 to +12; voters 65 and over from Paxton +17 to +18.

READING THE COLUMNS

Undecided falls to 1 percent or less in every group with a full base. Education uses the report's derived-table labels: High School, College and Graduate School.

REPORTING NOTE

* = limited base, directional. Column counts are calibrated weighted equivalents, not unweighted respondent counts. Initial and combined results are separate findings.

Senate ballot with leaners allocated, by party and metro type

Whole-number column percentages within each subgroup after leaners are allocated. Base n=1,207. Column counts are calibrated weighted equivalents.

Paxton +1.0

Paxton margin, with leaners

PARTY ID (MODELED)

RESPONSE	REPUBLICAN weighted n=563	DEMOCRAT weighted n=477	INDEPENDENT* weighted n=167
Ken Paxton, Republican	94%	2%	34%
James Talarico, Democrat	4%	97%	58%
Ted Brown, Libertarian	1%	1%	4%
Undecided	0%	1%	3%
Margin	Paxton +90	Talarico +95	Talarico +24

METRO TYPE

RESPONSE	URBAN weighted n=451	SUBURBAN weighted n=403	RURAL weighted n=269	TOWN* weighted n=84
Ken Paxton, Republican	37%	50%	67%	61%
James Talarico, Democrat	62%	48%	31%	35%
Ted Brown, Libertarian	0%	2%	2%	2%
Undecided	1%	0%	0%	2%
Margin	Talarico +25	Paxton +2	Paxton +36	Paxton +26

PARTY

Republicans reach 94 percent for Paxton and Democrats 97 percent for Talarico once leaners are allocated. Independents go 58 Talarico to 34, with 3 percent still undecided.

PLACE

Urban voters go Talarico 62 to 37, suburban voters Paxton 50 to 48, rural voters Paxton 67 to 31 and town voters Paxton 61 to 35.

REPORTING NOTE

* = limited base, directional. Independent and town columns are flagged directional in the derived tables. Media market is not broken out for the leaner ballot.

Movement since the October 9 to 11 survey

The Senate ballot in both Quantus surveys, by group. Change is the shift in the Paxton-minus-Talarico margin, in points.

Paxton +0.6

net shift in margin since Oct. 9 to 11

TOPLINE, INITIAL BALLOT

	Oct. 9 to 11	Oct. 26 to 28	Change
Paxton (R)	47.2	48.7	+1.5
Talarico (D)	46.7	47.6	+0.9
Undecided	3.9	2.2	-1.7
Brown (L)	2.2	1.4	-0.8
Margin	Paxton +0.5	Paxton +1.1	R +0.6

SAMPLE COMPOSITION, PARTY ID (MODELED)

	Oct. 9 to 11	Oct. 26 to 28	Change
Republican	44.6	46.7	+2.1
Democrat	34.8	39.4	+4.6
Independent	20.6	13.9	-6.7

Sample n was 854 (839 race voters) on October 9 to 11 and 1,221 (1,207 race voters) on October 26 to 28. The first survey raked to media market; this survey rakes to congressional district. Whole-number column percentages from each survey's crosstabs; change is the difference in the two margins, with R meaning a shift toward Paxton and D a shift toward Talarico. Group shifts should be read against subgroup margins of error, which are wider than the full-sample ±3.6 and ±3.2.

SENATE BALLOT BY GROUP, BOTH SURVEYS

	Oct. 9 to 11			Oct. 26 to 28			Margin		
Group	Paxton	Talarico	Undec.	Paxton	Talarico	Undec.	Oct. 9 to 11	Oct. 26 to 28	Change
GENDER									
Women	42	52	5	45	52	2	Talarico +10	Talarico +7	R +3
Men	53	41	3	54	43	2	Paxton +12	Paxton +11	D +1
AGE									
18-29	29	62	6	28	66	3	Talarico +33	Talarico +38	D +5
30-44	40	53	4	39	55	3	Talarico +13	Talarico +16	D +3
45-64	49	45	4	53	45	1	Paxton +4	Paxton +8	R +4
65+	56	39	3	57	40	2	Paxton +17	Paxton +17	0
RACE / ETHNICITY									
White	59	36	2	61	36	2	Paxton +23	Paxton +25	R +2
Hispanic	37	55	7	36	59	3	Talarico +18	Talarico +23	D +5
Black	10	82	6	13	84	3	Talarico +72	Talarico +71	R +1
PARTY ID									
Republican	87	7	3	93	4	2	Paxton +80	Paxton +89	R +9
Democrat	2	95	2	2	96	2	Talarico +93	Talarico +94	D +1
Independent	37	52	9	33	57	6	Talarico +15	Talarico +24	D +9
METRO TYPE									
Urban	34	60	4	36	61	3	Talarico +26	Talarico +25	R +1
Suburban	50	45	2	49	47	2	Paxton +5	Paxton +2	D +3
Rural	64	30	5	66	31	2	Paxton +34	Paxton +35	R +1
MEDIA MARKET									
Dallas-Ft. Worth	45	49	3	47	48	3	Talarico +4	Talarico +1	R +3
Houston	46	49	4	46	50	2	Talarico +3	Talarico +4	D +1
San Antonio	48	49	3	45	52	2	Talarico +1	Talarico +7	D +6
Austin	40	57	0	36	62	1	Talarico +17	Talarico +26	D +9

SECTION TWO

The Governor ballot

The Abbott and Hinojosa ballot, the ballot with leaners allocated, and demographic and media-market detail.

QUESTIONS

Q4, Q5

STRUCTURE

Topline, leaners, demographic detail

BASES

n = 1,214 race voters; Q5 n = 28

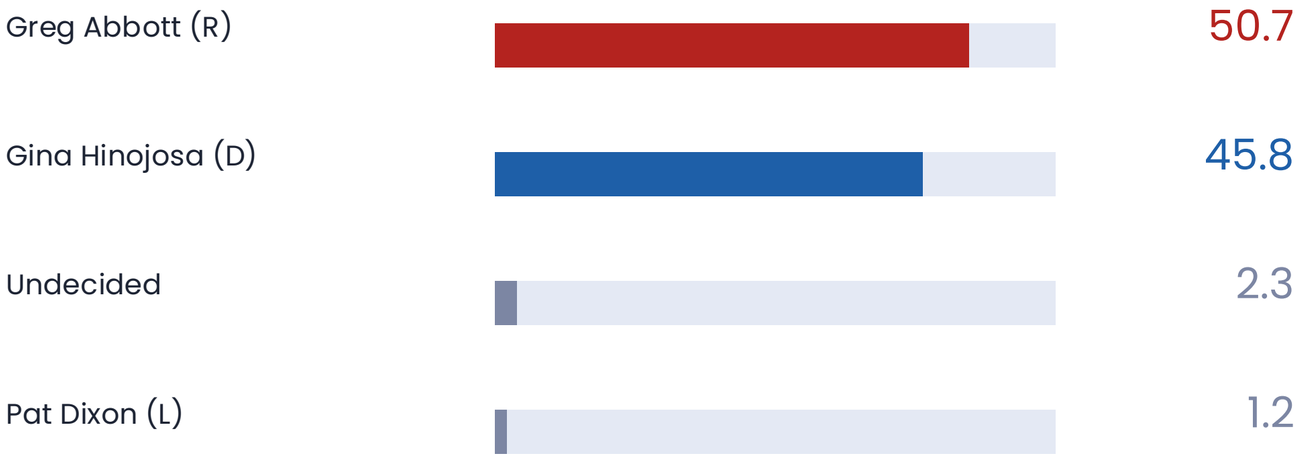
Q4 · GOVERNOR BALLOT

If the election for Governor of Texas were held today, for whom would you vote?

Asked of race voters, n=1,214. Respondents who had already voted were asked for whom they voted.

Abbott +4.9

Abbott margin, initial ballot



TWO-WAY SHARE



MARGIN BY GROUP

Women	Hinojosa +3
Men	Abbott +13
Independents	Hinojosa +18
Suburban	Abbott +5
Rural	Abbott +31
Hispanic voters	Hinojosa +19

THE MARGIN

Abbott leads by 4.9 points, inside the roughly ±6.4 margin on a difference between two candidates. Abbott runs 2.0 points ahead of Paxton; Hinojosa runs 1.8 behind Talarico.

THE REST OF THE BALLOT

Pat Dixon, the Libertarian, draws 1.2 percent; 2.3 percent are undecided. The 7 respondents who would not vote in this race are excluded from the base, and the remaining responses are renormalized to 100.

REPORTING NOTE

Column percentages on the race-voters base of 1,214. Group margins are differences in whole-number column percentages from the crosstabs; topline margins are computed from unrounded shares.

Q4 + Q5 · GOVERNOR BALLOT WITH LEANERS

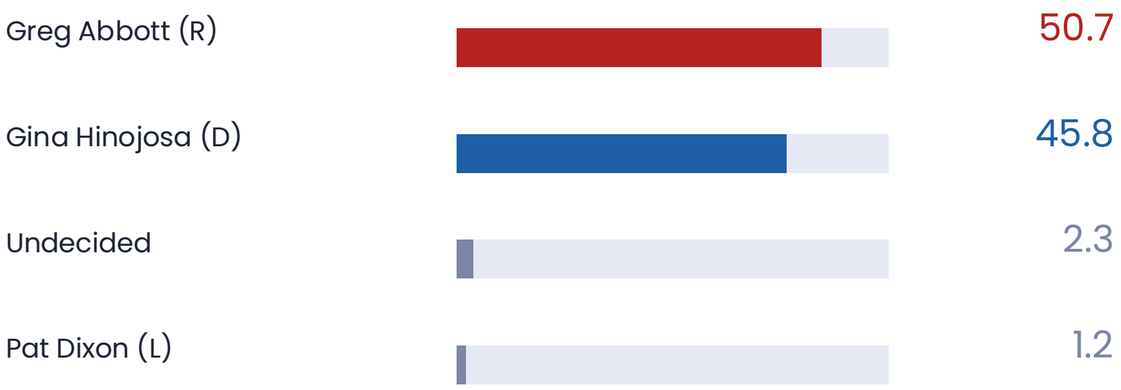
Even if you are not sure, which candidate for Governor do you lean toward?

Abbott +5.3

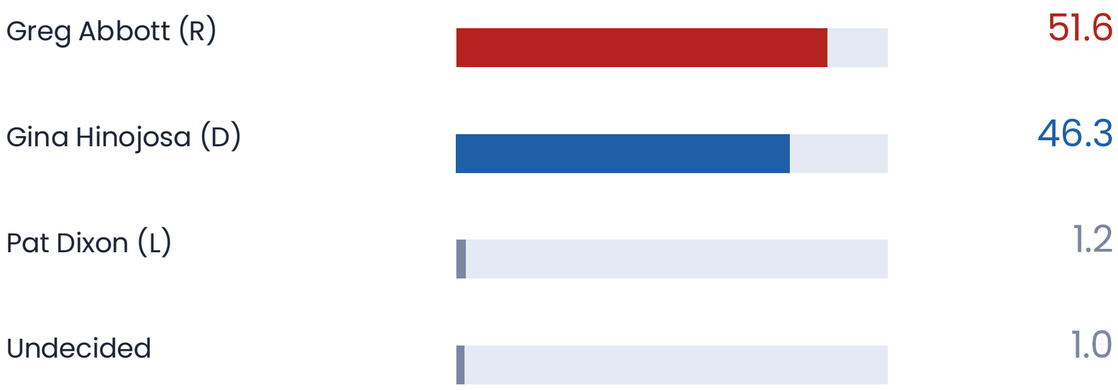
Abbott margin, with leaners

Asked of the 28 undecided respondents on Q4. Leaners are allocated back into the ballot to produce the combined result.

INITIAL BALLOT · Q4 · N=1,214



BALLOT WITH LEANERS ALLOCATED · N=1,214



HOW THE 28 UNDECIDED RESPONDENTS BROKE · Q5 · BASE N=28, DIRECTIONAL

43.4	33.7	22.9
Still undecided n=12	Greg Abbott, the Republican n=10	Gina Hinojosa, the Democrat n=6

WHAT CHANGED

Allocating leaners adds 0.9 to Abbott and 0.5 to Hinojosa; the ballot goes from 50.7 to 45.8 to 51.6 to 46.3. Undecided falls from 2.3 to 1.0 percent. Dixon is unchanged at 1.2.

HOW TO READ IT

The lean question was asked of 28 people, so the split is directional. Ten leaned Abbott and six Hinojosa, which widens the margin by four tenths of a point.

REPORTING NOTE

Combined ballot shares come from the report's derived analysis (Abbott n=626, Hinojosa n=562, Dixon n=14, undecided n=12 on the 1,214 base). Initial and combined results are separate findings.

If the election for Governor of Texas were held today, for whom would you vote?

Whole-number column percentages within each subgroup. Race-voters base n=1,214, margin of error ±3.2.

Abbott +4.9

Abbott margin, initial ballot

GENDER

RESPONSE	WOMEN n=658	MEN n=556
Greg Abbott, Republican	47%	55%
Gina Hinojosa, Democrat	50%	42%
Undecided	2%	2%
Pat Dixon, Libertarian	1%	1%
Margin	Hinojosa +3	Abbott +13

AGE

RESPONSE	18-29 n=130	30-44 n=259	45-64 n=438	65+ n=387
Greg Abbott, Republican	34%	44%	53%	58%
Gina Hinojosa, Democrat	59%	52%	44%	40%
Undecided	4%	3%	2%	1%
Pat Dixon, Libertarian	3%	1%	1%	0%
Margin	Hinojosa +25	Hinojosa +8	Abbott +9	Abbott +18

RACE / ETHNICITY (MODELED)

RESPONSE	WHITE n=725	HISPANIC n=288	BLACK n=125	ASIAN* n=44	OTHER* n=32
Greg Abbott, Republican	63%	37%	14%	40%	40%
Gina Hinojosa, Democrat	35%	56%	82%	53%	49%
Undecided	1%	5%	3%	3%	5%
Pat Dixon, Libertarian	1%	2%	0%	5%	5%
Margin	Abbott +28	Hinojosa +19	Hinojosa +68	Hinojosa +13	Hinojosa +9

EDUCATION

RESPONSE	HS-SOME COLLEGE n=703	COLLEGE n=326	GRADUATE SCHOOL n=185
Greg Abbott, Republican	55%	46%	43%
Gina Hinojosa, Democrat	41%	52%	54%
Undecided	3%	2%	1%
Pat Dixon, Libertarian	1%	1%	1%
Margin	Abbott +14	Hinojosa +6	Hinojosa +11

GENDER AND AGE

Women back Hinojosa by 3 points; men back Abbott by 13. Voters under 45 go Hinojosa; voters 45 to 64 go Abbott by 9 and 65 and over by 18.

RACE AND EDUCATION

White voters go Abbott 63 to 35; Hispanic voters go Hinojosa 56 to 37 and Black voters 82 to 14. Voters with a high school education or some college go Abbott 55 to 41; college graduates go Hinojosa 52 to 46.

REPORTING NOTE

* = limited base, directional. Race and education are modeled from the voter file. Percentages run down each column and may not total 100 due to rounding.

If the election for Governor of Texas were held today, for whom would you vote?

Whole-number column percentages within each subgroup. Race-voters base n=1,214, margin of error ±3.2.

Abbott +4.9

Abbott margin, initial ballot

PARTY ID (MODELED)

RESPONSE	REPUBLICAN n=568	DEMOCRAT n=478	INDEPENDENT n=168
Greg Abbott, Republican	95%	4%	36%
Gina Hinojosa, Democrat	3%	94%	54%
Undecided	2%	2%	6%
Pat Dixon, Libertarian	1%	1%	5%
Margin	Abbott +92	Hinojosa +90	Hinojosa +18

METRO TYPE

RESPONSE	URBAN n=452	SUBURBAN n=408	RURAL n=272	TOWN n=82
Greg Abbott, Republican	41%	50%	64%	58%
Gina Hinojosa, Democrat	56%	45%	33%	42%
Undecided	2%	3%	2%	0%
Pat Dixon, Libertarian	1%	2%	1%	0%
Margin	Hinojosa +15	Abbott +5	Abbott +31	Abbott +16

MEDIA MARKET

RESPONSE	DALLAS-FT. WORTH n=380	HOUSTON n=306	SAN ANTONIO n=128	AUSTIN n=122
Greg Abbott, Republican	51%	50%	44%	37%
Gina Hinojosa, Democrat	45%	47%	50%	61%
Undecided	2%	2%	2%	2%
Pat Dixon, Libertarian	1%	1%	4%	0%
Margin	Abbott +6	Abbott +3	Hinojosa +6	Hinojosa +24

PARTY

Republicans hold at 95 percent for Abbott and Democrats at 94 percent for Hinojosa. Independents go 54 Hinojosa to 36, with 6 percent undecided and 5 percent for Dixon.

PLACE

Urban voters go Hinojosa by 15 and rural voters Abbott by 31; the suburbs are Abbott 50 to 45. Dallas-Ft. Worth is Abbott 51 to 45 and Houston 50 to 47; San Antonio is Hinojosa 50 to 44 and Austin 61 to 37.

REPORTING NOTE

Party is the mapped voter-file field. Media market shows the four markets with bases above 100; the sixteen smaller markets are directional and appear in the full report.

Governor ballot with leaners allocated, by demographic group

Whole-number column percentages within each subgroup after leaners are allocated. Base n=1,214. Column counts are calibrated weighted equivalents.

Abbott +5.3

Abbott margin, with leaners

GENDER

RESPONSE	WOMEN weighted n=658	MEN weighted n=556
Greg Abbott, Republican	47%	56%
Gina Hinojosa, Democrat	50%	42%
Pat Dixon, Libertarian	1%	1%
Undecided	1%	1%
Margin	Hinojosa +3	Abbott +14

AGE

RESPONSE	18-29* weighted n=130	30-44 weighted n=259	45-64 weighted n=438	65+ weighted n=387
Greg Abbott, Republican	34%	45%	54%	59%
Gina Hinojosa, Democrat	59%	53%	44%	41%
Pat Dixon, Libertarian	3%	1%	1%	0%
Undecided	4%	0%	1%	0%
Margin	Hinojosa +25	Hinojosa +8	Abbott +10	Abbott +18

RACE / ETHNICITY (MODELED)

RESPONSE	WHITE weighted n=725	HISPANIC weighted n=288	BLACK* weighted n=125	ASIAN* weighted n=44	OTHER* weighted n=32
Greg Abbott, Republican	64%	39%	15%	40%	40%
Gina Hinojosa, Democrat	35%	57%	84%	53%	49%
Pat Dixon, Libertarian	1%	2%	0%	5%	5%
Undecided	0%	2%	1%	3%	5%
Margin	Abbott +29	Hinojosa +18	Hinojosa +69	Hinojosa +13	Hinojosa +9

EDUCATION

RESPONSE	HIGH SCHOOL weighted n=703	COLLEGE weighted n=326	GRADUATE SCHOOL weighted n=185
Greg Abbott, Republican	56%	46%	43%
Gina Hinojosa, Democrat	41%	52%	56%
Pat Dixon, Libertarian	1%	1%	1%
Undecided	1%	1%	0%
Margin	Abbott +15	Hinojosa +6	Hinojosa +13

WHAT MOVES

Allocating the 28 leaners changes most groups by a point or less. Men go from Abbott +13 to +14; voters 45 to 64 from Abbott +9 to +10; Hispanic voters from Hinojosa +19 to +18.

READING THE COLUMNS

Undecided falls to 1 percent or less in every group with a full base. Education uses the report's derived-table labels: High School, College and Graduate School.

REPORTING NOTE

* = limited base, directional. Column counts are calibrated weighted equivalents, not unweighted respondent counts. Initial and combined results are separate findings.

Governor ballot with leaners allocated, by party and metro type

Whole-number column percentages within each subgroup after leaners are allocated. Base n=1,214. Column counts are calibrated weighted equivalents.

Abbott +5.3

Abbott margin, with leaners

PARTY ID (MODELED)

RESPONSE	REPUBLICAN weighted n=568	DEMOCRAT weighted n=478	INDEPENDENT* weighted n=168
Greg Abbott, Republican	95%	4%	38%
Gina Hinojosa, Democrat	3%	95%	55%
Pat Dixon, Libertarian	1%	1%	5%
Undecided	1%	1%	2%
Margin	Abbott +92	Hinojosa +91	Hinojosa +17

METRO TYPE

RESPONSE	URBAN weighted n=452	SUBURBAN weighted n=408	RURAL weighted n=272	TOWN* weighted n=82
Greg Abbott, Republican	42%	52%	65%	58%
Gina Hinojosa, Democrat	57%	45%	33%	42%
Pat Dixon, Libertarian	1%	2%	1%	0%
Undecided	1%	1%	1%	0%
Margin	Hinojosa +15	Abbott +7	Abbott +32	Abbott +16

PARTY

Republicans hold at 95 percent for Abbott and Democrats reach 95 percent for Hinojosa once leaners are allocated. Independents go 55 Hinojosa to 38, with 2 percent still undecided.

PLACE

Urban voters go Hinojosa 57 to 42, suburban voters Abbott 52 to 45, rural voters Abbott 65 to 33 and town voters Abbott 58 to 42.

REPORTING NOTE

* = limited base, directional. Independent and town columns are flagged directional in the derived tables. Media market is not broken out for the leaner ballot.

SECTION THREE

Texas in context

The two ballots against the state's regional map, its statewide results since 2008, and the published polling averages.

QUESTIONS

Q2 and Q4 in context

STRUCTURE

Regional map and statewide benchmarks

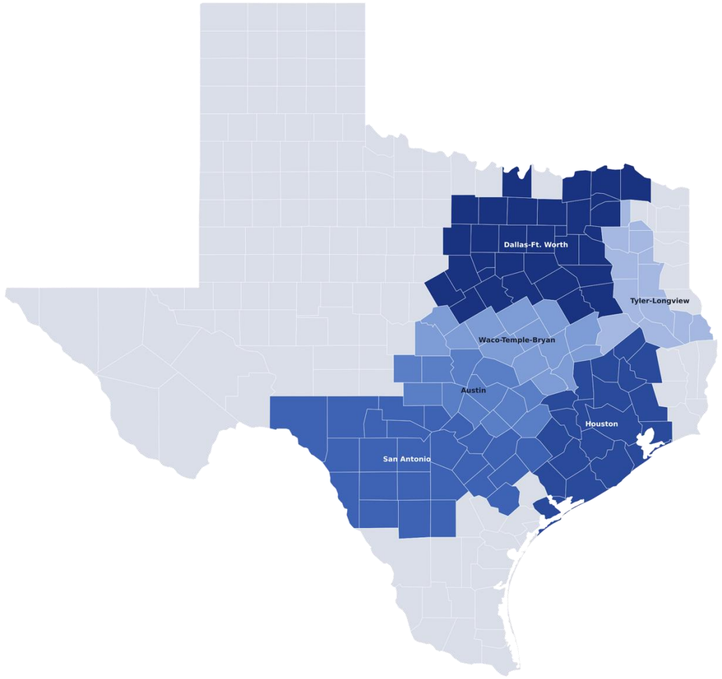
BASES

Certified returns, 2008 to 2024; published polling averages

REGIONAL CONTEXT

Where Texas's vote comes from

Certified margins by media market in 2020 and 2024, and the Senate and Governor ballots in this survey.



Regions are the Nielsen media markets used in this survey, built from certified county returns for all 254 counties. Tints mark the six largest markets; the fourteen remaining markets are shown in grey as rest of state.

MARGIN BY REGION, 2020 AND 2024, AND IN THIS SURVEY

REGION	SHARE OF 2024 VOTE	2020 PRESIDENT	2020 SENATE	2024 PRESIDENT	2024 SENATE	SENATE, THIS SURVEY	GOVERNOR, THIS SURVEY
Statewide	100%	R +5.6	R +9.6	R +13.7	R +8.5	Paxton +1	Abbott +5
Dallas-Ft. Worth	30%	R +4.4	R +9.6	R +11.9	R +6.4	Talarico +1	Abbott +6
Houston	25%	R +1.6	R +5.9	R +9.3	R +3.9	Talarico +4	Abbott +3
Austin	10%	D +20.7	D +15.6	D +14.2	D +18.2	Talarico +26	Hinojosa +24
San Antonio	10%	R +0.4	R +5.3	R +9.2	R +3.1	Talarico +7	Hinojosa +6
Waco-Temple-Bryan	4%	R +23.1	R +26.6	R +31.0	R +26.7	n/a	n/a
Tyler-Longview	3%	R +46.5	R +47.7	R +51.9	R +48.9	n/a	n/a
Rest of state	18%	R +20.5	R +22.0	R +31.4	R +26.4	n/a	n/a

President: Biden and Trump 2020, Harris and Trump 2024. Senate: Hegar and Cornyn 2020, Allred and Cruz 2024. Democratic minus Republican share of all votes, from certified county returns. Share is the region's portion of the 2024 vote. Survey columns are differences in whole-number column percentages on the race-voters bases; the statewide survey margin uses the unrounded topline. Markets with bases under 100 are directional and are not shown.

THE TWO BIG MARKETS

Dallas-Ft. Worth casts 30 percent of the vote and Houston 25. Both went Trump by 12 and 9 in 2024 and Cruz by 6 and 4. In this survey both are within a few points on the Senate ballot and Abbott +6 and +3 for Governor.

WHERE THE BALLOTS DIFFER

The Senate ballot runs to the left of the 2024 Senate result in every market shown: Dallas-Ft. Worth by about 7 points, Houston 8, Austin 8 and San Antonio 10. The Governor ballot is closer to 2024 in Dallas-Ft. Worth and Houston.

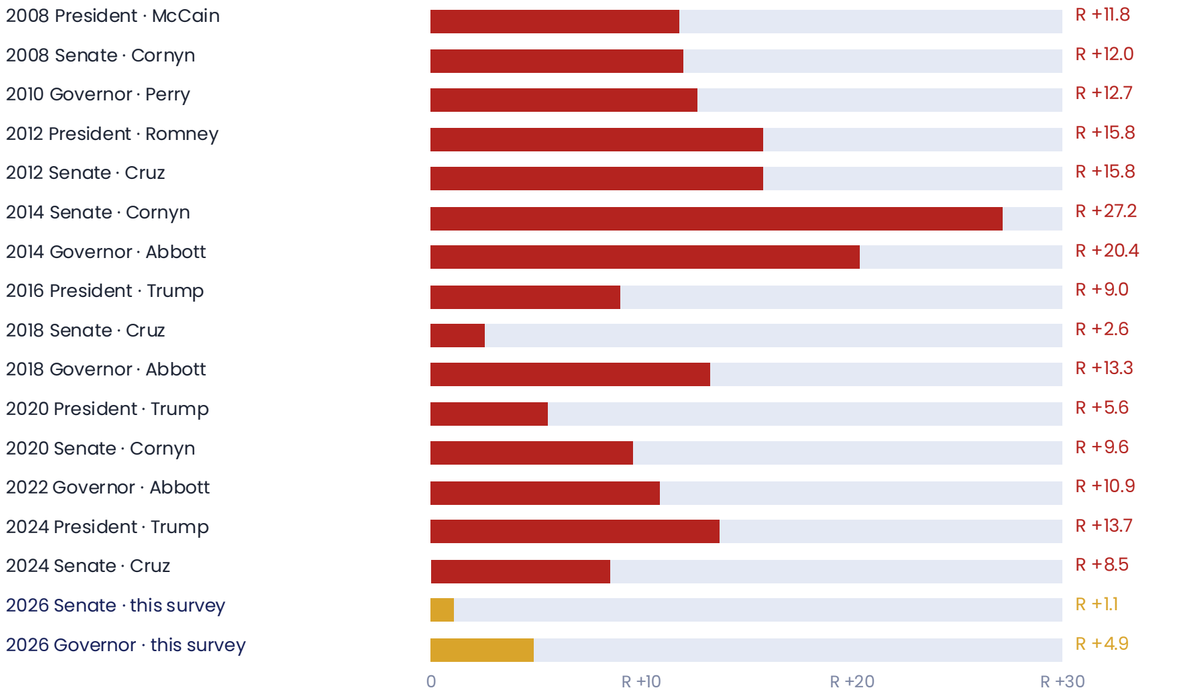
REPORTING NOTE

2024 Senate is the certified Cruz and Allred margin. Statewide survey margins are Paxton +1.1 and Abbott +4.9 from the unrounded toplines; whole-number column percentages give Paxton +1 and Abbott +5.

A red state narrowed to even; a race the averages call Talarico +2 to +4

Certified statewide margins since 2008, the two ballots in this survey, and the published polling averages at the end of fieldwork.

STATEWIDE MARGIN, REPUBLICAN, POINTS



PUBLISHED POLLING AVERAGES · U.S. SENATE

SOURCE	PAXTON	TALARICO	MARGIN
Quantus Insights Oct. 26 to 28, this survey	48.7	47.6	Paxton +1.1
RealClearPolling Polls Oct. 8 to 27	46.5	48.6	Talarico +2.1
270toWin Average of six polls through Oct. 29	45.8	49.3	Talarico +3.5
Pollsmax As of Oct. 29	45.5	48.2	Talarico +2.7
PollCheck Updated Oct. 27	45.8	48.4	Talarico +2.6

PUBLISHED POLLING AVERAGES · GOVERNOR

SOURCE	ABBOTT	HINOJOSA	MARGIN
Quantus Insights Oct. 26 to 28, this survey	50.7	45.8	Abbott +4.9
RealClearPolling Average of ten polls, as of Oct. 19	48.8	46.7	Abbott +2.1
PollCheck Updated Oct. 27	48.8	46.3	Abbott +2.5

Aggregator figures as published October 27 to 29, 2026; shares in percent. RealClearPolling lists the Senate race as a Toss Up.

THE BENCHMARK

Texas has voted Republican in every statewide race since 1994. The closest result of the period was Cruz's 2.6-point win in 2018; Cruz won by 8.5 in 2024 and Trump by 13.7.

THE CANDIDATE RECORD

Paxton won three terms as Attorney General, by 20.8, 3.6 and 9.8, and took the May 26 runoff over Cornyn 63.8 to 36.2. Talarico won the March 3 primary with 52 percent. Abbott is seeking a fourth term after wins of 20.4, 13.3 and 10.9.

AGAINST THE AVERAGES

Paxton's 48.7 is above the aggregators' 45.5 to 46.5; Talarico's 47.6 is below their 48.2 to 49.3. Paxton +1.1 against Talarico +2.1 to +3.5 is a gap of about 3 to 5 points, inside the ±6.4 margin on a difference.

SECTION FOUR

Turnout, ticket splitting and the 2024 baseline

Who had already voted, how voters plan to handle the two races together, how many Abbott voters they expect to cross over, and how the sample recalls its 2024 presidential vote.

QUESTIONS

Q1, Q6, Q7, Q8

STRUCTURE

Topline and demographic detail

BASES

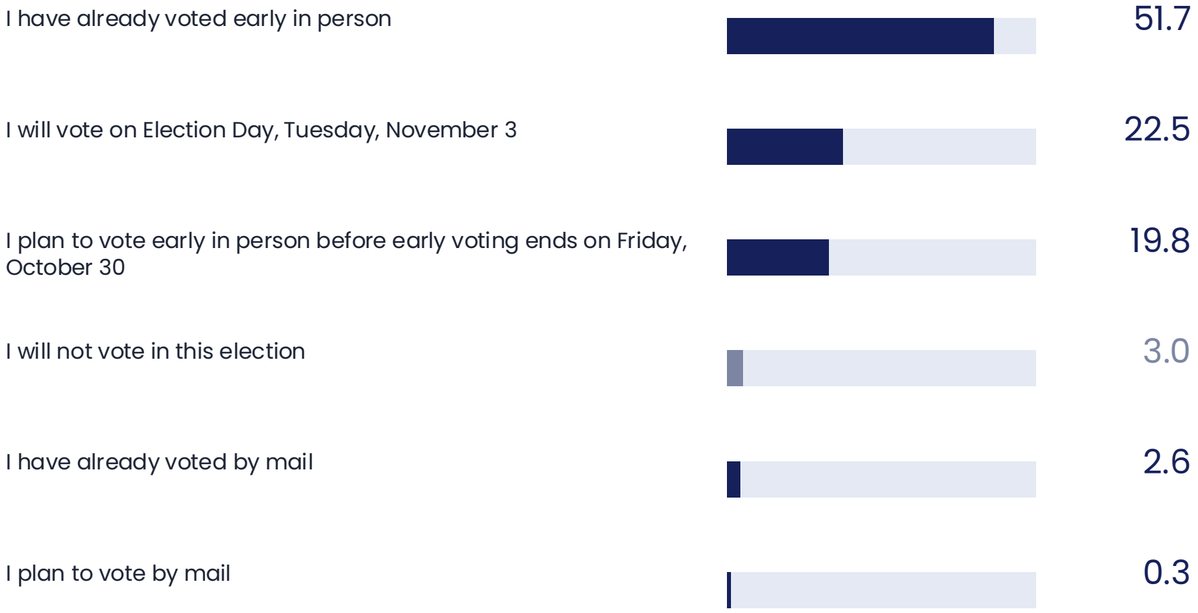
n = 1,221; Q8 n = 1,168 race voters

Vote status at the time of interview

Asked of the full reporting base, n=1,221. Early voting ran from October 19 to October 30.

54.3

percent had already voted



PARTY ID (MODELED)

RESPONSE	REPUBLICAN n=570	DEMOCRAT n=481	INDEPENDENT n=170
Already voted early in person	49%	59%	41%
Plan to vote early in person	21%	17%	26%
Will vote on Election Day	25%	18%	25%
Already voted by mail	2%	3%	1%
Will not vote	3%	2%	6%
Plan to vote by mail	0%	0%	1%

AGE

RESPONSE	18-29 n=131	30-44 n=261	45-64 n=441	65+ n=388
Already voted early in person	55%	52%	51%	51%
Plan to vote early in person	8%	23%	24%	17%
Will vote on Election Day	32%	19%	22%	22%
Already voted by mail	0%	1%	2%	5%
Will not vote	5%	5%	1%	3%
Plan to vote by mail	0%	0%	0%	1%

ALREADY IN

54.3 percent of likely voters had voted by the end of fieldwork on October 28: 51.7 early in person and 2.6 by mail. Another 19.8 percent planned to vote early before it closed on October 30 and 22.5 percent on Election Day.

BY PARTY

Democrats report the highest rate of having already voted, 59 percent early in person, against 49 percent of Republicans and 41 percent of independents. Republicans and independents are more likely to say they will vote on Election Day, 25 percent each.

REPORTING NOTE

Full reporting base of 1,221, including the 3.0 percent who say they will not vote. Vote status is self-reported at the time of interview and is not a turnout projection.

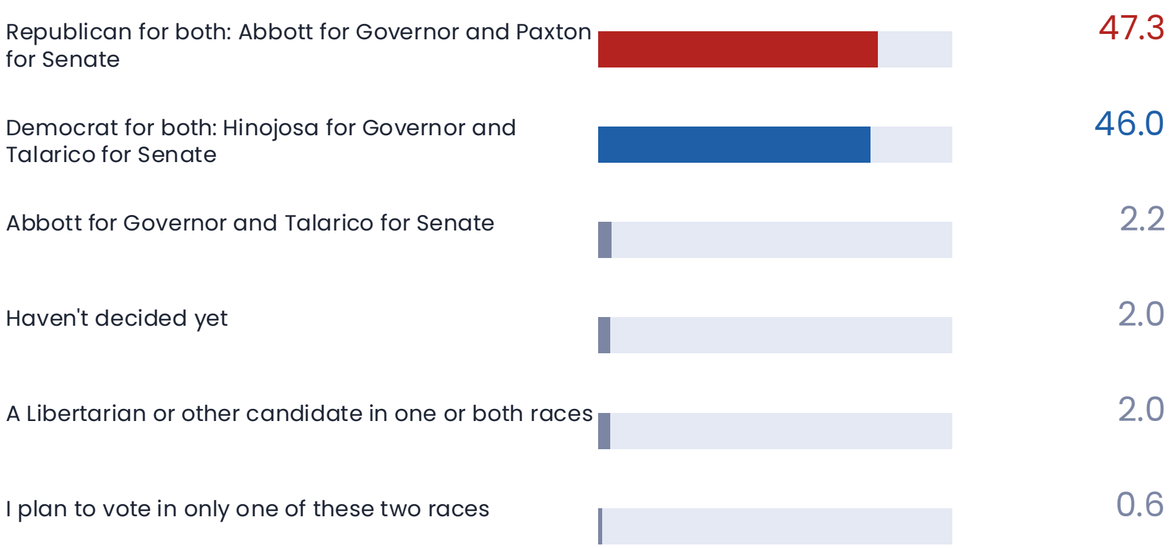
Q6 · SENATE AND GOVERNOR TOGETHER

Thinking about the races for Governor and U.S. Senate together, which of the following best describes your vote?

Asked of the full reporting base, n=1,221.

R +1.3

straight Republican minus straight Democratic



PARTY ID (MODELED)

RESPONSE	REPUBLICAN n=570	DEMOCRAT n=481	INDEPENDENT n=170
Democrat for both	4%	93%	53%
Republican for both	90%	3%	30%
Haven't decided	2%	2%	3%
Libertarian or other	2%	1%	6%
Abbott and Talarico	2%	1%	6%
Only one race	1%	0%	1%

METRO TYPE

RESPONSE	URBAN n=456	SUBURBAN n=408	RURAL n=272	TOWN n=85
Democrat for both	58%	45%	31%	35%
Republican for both	34%	49%	63%	59%
Haven't decided	2%	3%	0%	0%
Libertarian or other	2%	3%	1%	1%
Abbott and Talarico	3%	0%	4%	0%
Only one race	1%	0%	0%	5%

STRAIGHT TICKETS

93.3 percent of likely voters plan to vote the same party in both races: 47.3 straight Republican and 46.0 straight Democratic. The gap, R +1.3, sits between the Senate margin and the Governor margin.

THE SPLIT

2.2 percent plan to vote Abbott for Governor and Talarico for Senate. Among independents the figure is 6 percent; among Republicans 2 percent. The reverse split, Hinojosa and Paxton, was not offered as a response option.

REPORTING NOTE

Full reporting base of 1,221, including respondents who would not vote in one race. Tables show party and metro type; the other banners are in the full report.

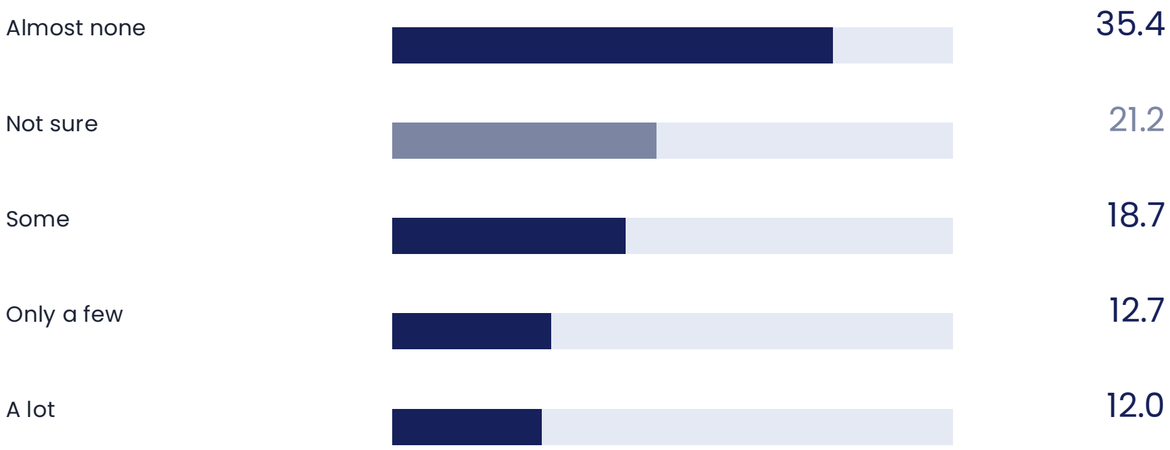
Q7 · PERCEIVED CROSSOVER

Regardless of how you plan to vote, how many Texans who vote for Greg Abbott for Governor do you think will also vote for James Talarico for Senate?

Asked of the full reporting base, n=1,221.

35.4

percent say almost none



AGE				
RESPONSE	18-29 n=131	30-44 n=261	45-64 n=441	65+ n=388
Almost none	53%	27%	33%	38%
Not sure	6%	15%	27%	24%
Some	21%	25%	16%	16%
Only a few	6%	17%	12%	12%
A lot	14%	15%	11%	10%

PARTY ID (MODELED)			
RESPONSE	REPUBLICAN n=570	DEMOCRAT n=481	INDEPENDENT n=170
Almost none	53%	13%	29%
Not sure	14%	23%	21%
Some	15%	25%	29%
Only a few	12%	16%	13%
A lot	7%	24%	8%

METRO TYPE				
RESPONSE	URBAN n=456	SUBURBAN n=408	RURAL n=272	TOWN n=85
Almost none	29%	37%	45%	31%
Not sure	17%	25%	22%	21%
Some	27%	14%	11%	24%
Only a few	15%	13%	9%	13%
A lot	12%	11%	14%	12%

THE READ

35.4 percent of likely voters expect almost no Abbott voters to cross over for Talarico; 30.7 percent expect some or a lot. 21.2 percent are not sure.

BY PARTY

Republicans are the most skeptical: 53 percent say almost none. Democrats are the most optimistic: 24 percent say a lot and 25 percent say some. Independents split 29 almost none, 29 some.

REPORTING NOTE

Full reporting base of 1,221. Responses are shown in the order the report lists them. Tables show age, party and metro type; the other banners are in the full report.

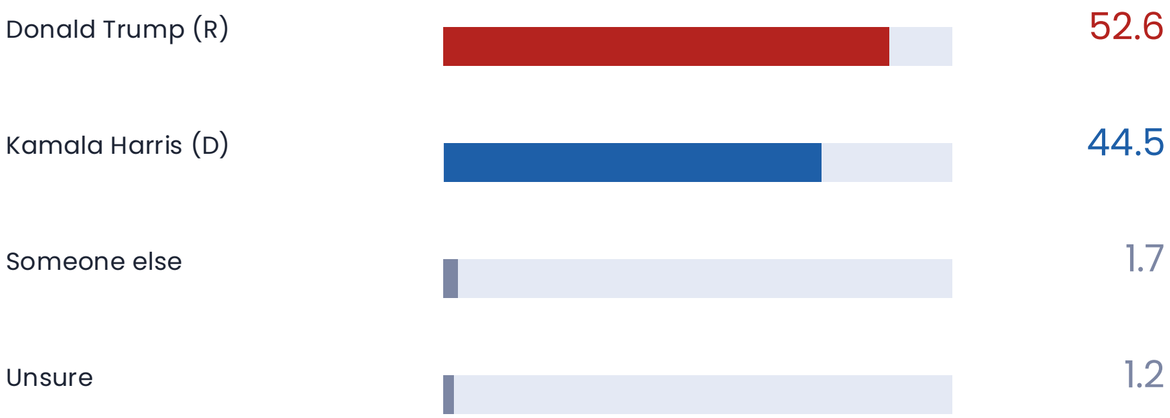
Q8 · 2024 PRESIDENTIAL VOTE RECALL

In the 2024 election for President, did you vote for Republican Donald Trump, Democrat Kamala Harris, someone else, or did you not vote in that race?

Asked of the full base; the 53 respondents who did not vote in that race are excluded, n=1,168.

Trump +8.1

Trump margin, recalled 2024 vote



RECALLED VS. CERTIFIED 2024 RESULT

54.2	56.9	Trump +8.1	Trump +13.7
Trump two-way, recalled	Trump two-way, certified	Recalled margin	Certified margin

GENDER

RESPONSE	WOMEN n=637	MEN n=531
Donald Trump	47%	59%
Kamala Harris	50%	38%
Someone else	2%	1%
Unsure	1%	1%

PARTY ID (MODELED)

RESPONSE	REPUBLICAN n=557	DEMOCRAT n=456	INDEPENDENT n=155
Donald Trump	95%	3%	45%
Kamala Harris	3%	94%	48%
Someone else	1%	1%	6%
Unsure	1%	1%	2%

METRO TYPE

RESPONSE	URBAN n=443	SUBURBAN n=375	RURAL n=265	TOWN n=85
Donald Trump	42%	54%	63%	70%
Kamala Harris	55%	42%	35%	30%
Someone else	2%	3%	0%	0%
Unsure	1%	1%	1%	0%

THE BASELINE

Respondents who voted in 2024 recall a 52.6 to 44.5 Trump vote, an 8.1-point margin. Texas's certified 2024 result was Trump 56.1 to Harris 42.5, a 13.7-point margin; Cruz won the Senate race by 8.5.

WHAT IT MEANS

The sample recalls a margin 5.6 points narrower than the certified result. Recall typically understates a winner's margin, and the pipeline audits this gap against certified returns rather than weighting to the recall itself.

REPORTING NOTE

Race-voters base of 1,168. Two-way shares divide each candidate by the Trump plus Harris total. Certified result from the Texas Secretary of State.

What each number can carry

MARGIN OF ERROR BY BASE SIZE

ANALYSIS BASE	95% MARGIN OF ERROR	REPORTABLE
1,221 analytical base	±3.2 pts	Yes
300 to 400	±5.5 to ±6.4 pts	Yes
150 to 250	±7.0 to ±9.1 pts	Yes, with base
80 to 149	±9.1 to ±12.4 pts	Report with base and uncertainty
Under 80*	wider than ±12.4 pts	Directional, shown for transparency

Margins are calculated at the 95 percent confidence level for an estimate near 50 percent and include the survey design effect of 1.28. Conditional follow-up questions (Q3, Q5) do not use the full-sample margin of error. Subgroups marked * should be interpreted as directional. The margin on a difference between two candidates is roughly twice the single-share margin, about ±6.4.

QUESTION BASES

Q1 · Vote status	n=1,221
Q2 · U.S. Senate ballot, race voters only	n=1,207
Q3 · Senate lean, asked of Q2 undecided	n=27
Q4 · Governor ballot, race voters only	n=1,214
Q5 · Governor lean, asked of Q4 undecided	n=28
Q6 · Senate and Governor together	n=1,221
Q7 · Perceived Abbott to Talarico crossover	n=1,221
Q8 · 2024 presidential vote recall, voters only	n=1,168

SMALL BASES IN THIS WAVE

Asian Race / ethnicity (modeled)	n=44
Other Race / ethnicity (modeled)	n=32
Town Metro type	n=84
Waco-Temple-Bryan Media market	n=40
Corpus Christi Media market	n=39
Tyler-Longview (Lfkn & Ncgd) Media market	n=36
El Paso (Las Cruces) Media market	n=20
Harlingen-Wslco-Brnsvl-McA Media market	n=21
Amarillo Media market	n=20
Ten remaining markets Media market, none above 17	n≤17

Bases are for Q2 where the report gives them; the remaining markets are full-sample counts. Age 18-29 (n=129) and Black voters (n=124) are reportable with their base and uncertainty.

AT A GLANCE

The headline figures

Paxton +1.1

U.S. Senate ballot, race voters

Abbott +4.9

Governor ballot, race voters

Talarico +24

Senate margin among independents

Hinojosa +18

Governor margin among independents

Talarico +7

Senate margin among women

Paxton +11

Senate margin among men

Paxton +2

Senate margin in the suburbs, 49 to 47

Paxton +35

Senate margin among rural voters

54.3

Percent who had already voted by October 28

R +1.3

Straight Republican minus straight Democratic ticket

Trump +8.1

Recalled 2024 vote; certified Trump +13.7

R +0.6

Senate margin shift since Oct. 9 to 11

TWO RACES INSIDE THE MARGIN

Paxton leads by 1.1 and Abbott by 4.9; both are inside the roughly ±6.4 margin on a difference. Paxton holds men, white voters, rural and town voters and voters 45 and over; Talarico holds women, voters under 45, Hispanic and Black voters, urban voters and independents.

WHERE IT IS DECIDED

Independents, 13.9 percent of the sample, back Talarico 57 to 33 and Hinojosa 54 to 36. The suburbs are Paxton +2 on the Senate ballot and Abbott +5 for Governor. 2.2 percent plan the Abbott and Talarico split that would separate the two races.

REPORTING NOTE

Topline margins are computed from unrounded shares and may differ by a tenth from the rounded figures shown; group margins are differences in whole-number column percentages.

CONTACT

Questions, crosstabs and media requests

Prior releases and our polling archive are posted on the website.

PREPARED BY

Jason B. Corley

Co-founder and Lead Pollster, Quantus Insights

EMAIL

contact@quantusinsights.org

X / TWITTER

@QuantusInsights

WEBSITE

quantusinsights.org

FIELD DATES

October 26 to 28, 2026